

VPN & Remote Access Policy

IT-03 | Version 1.0 | Effective 01 September 2026

Owner: IT & Security | Applies to employees and contractors

Fictional company policy for RAG training and evaluation. All .example addresses are placeholders; these are not live services.

1. Purpose and scope

Provide secure remote access to internal systems. Employees and approved contractors must use the company VPN for internal applications outside the office network. Company cloud email and the support portal do not require VPN, but still require company sign-in and MFA.

2. Eligibility and approval

VPN use requires a company-issued, managed laptop, an active company account and registered MFA. The manager and IT must approve a VPN access ticket. Contractors also need a named employee sponsor; contractor VPN access expires after no more than 90 days and must be reapproved before renewal. Access approvals follow IT-04.

3. Connection procedure

Install Northstar Connect from the company software catalog. Connect to `vpn.northstar.example`, sign in with the company account and complete MFA. Confirm the client shows Connected before opening internal systems. The client checks disk encryption, endpoint protection, host firewall and update compliance under IT-02. A failed device check blocks connection; contact IT instead of bypassing it.

4. Session limits

VPN sessions disconnect after 30 minutes of inactivity or 12 hours of total connection time, whichever occurs first. Reconnect and complete MFA to start a new session. Only 1 concurrent VPN session per user is permitted. Disconnect when work is finished. Do not share a VPN account or allow another person to use an active session.

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Procedures and responsibilities

5. Networks and routing

Use a trusted home network or a personal mobile hotspot. Public Wi-Fi is permitted only with the company VPN active, and confidential work should be avoided in exposed locations. The company VPN uses full-tunnel routing: all network traffic goes through company controls while connected. Do not use another VPN simultaneously, alter routes or turn off the firewall.

6. Troubleshooting

If connection fails, confirm internet access, check the device clock, restart Northstar Connect and try once more. If the issue persists, open a ticket with the error message, time, client version and device asset tag. Never attach passwords or MFA codes. Five failed password attempts lock the account for 15 minutes under IT-01. Do not repeatedly retry during a lockout.

7. Restricted remote actions

Do not expose company remote desktop services directly to the internet. Privileged remote access requires the approved administrative gateway and the separate administrator account described in IT-04. A VPN connection does not grant new application permissions. Security may immediately terminate sessions if compromise is suspected.

8. Exceptions and related policies

Security must approve any exception in writing with an owner and an expiry of no more than 30 days. This policy does not allow personal laptops on the VPN. Use IT-01 for MFA recovery, IT-02 for device compliance and IT-05 for suspicious sign-ins.